

COOKING SKILLS

A comprehensive cooking skills curriculum covers fundamental knife handling, cooking methods (roasting, sautéing, boiling), Kitchen safety/hygiene, and flavor development. Programs often include **mise en place**, **menu planning**, **stock/soup preparation**, and **nutrition**. These courses cater to beginners up to professional levels, teaching students to cook from scratch and understand food components.

Curriculum Breakdown:

Foundation of Cooking Course Curriculum

- **Module 1: Kitchen Basics**

- **Safety & Hygiene:** Sanitation, food handling, HACCP, and allergen awareness. ○

Equipment Identification: Understanding commercial/home kitchen equipment. ○ **Kitchen**

Organization: Mise en place (setup), workflow, and efficiency.

- **Module 2: Knife Skills and Prep**

- **Knife Handling:** Safe handling, maintenance, and sharpening

- **Cutting Techniques:** Proper dicing, slicing, julienne, and batonnet techniques

- **Vegetable Prep:** Cleaning, prepping, and storing produce.

- **Module 3: Cooking Methods and Techniques**

- **Dry Heat Methods:** Roasting, baking, grilling, searing, and sautéing.

- **Moist Heat Methods:** Boiling, simmering, poaching, and steaming.

- **Fat-Based Methods:** Shallow frying, deep frying, and sweating.

- **Module 4: Stocks, Soups, and Sauces**

- **Stock Production:** Making chicken, vegetable, and beef stocks.

- **Soups:** Cream soups, broths, and consommés.
- **Mother Sauces:** Béchamel, Veloute, Espagnole, Tomato, and Hollandaise.

• Module 5: Ingredients and Flavor Development

- **Flavor Profiles:** Using herbs, spices, and aromatics.
- **Salt, Fat, Acid, and Heat:** Understanding the essential components of flavor.
- **Menu Planning:** Balancing texture, color, and taste in a meal.
- **Module 6:** Specialized Components
 - **Starch/Grains:** Rice, pasta, potato cookery
 - **Protein Cooking:** Poultry, meat, and fish preparation techniques.
 - **Salads/Dressings:** Cold preparations and emulsification.

• Module 7: Introduction to Pastry and Baking

- Basic pastry doughs, breads, or simple desserts

• Module 8: Final Assessment

- Practical demonstration of skills, such as preparing a three-course meal

Key Skills Developed:

- **Confidence** in the Kitchen
- Ability to **read and adapt recipes**
- **Menu planning** and basic costing